Kellen Donohue

Forward Deployed Software Engineer

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Bridging AI systems, data infrastructure, and enterprise deployments.

13+ years at Google, Palantir, and Postman building production software and data systems at scale. Taking ambiguous problems from concept to production: inference gateways, AI agents, proven integrations.

01 / EXPERIENCE

Postman — Forward Deployed Engineering — Oct 2025 - Present

Senior Forward Deployed Software Engineer

- Co-owned Lightyear, a wire-compatible inference gateway that cuts agentic token spend, accepting Claude, OpenAI, and Gemini traffic, routing across providers, and defending prompt-cache prefixes.
- Shipped the customer milestones agent zero to production, scoring contract requirements against delivery progress from Salesforce, Gong, and Redshift usage, now the data foundation for other internal agents.
- Built a prospect-scoring pipeline across 11 LLM-evaluated solution domains, publishing account leaderboards and sales briefs used in real conversions, exposed to the field as an MCP server.
- Shipped postman-bootstrap, a PyPI CLI capturing an HTTP service's behavior as a Postman oracle before AWS Transform modernizes it, plus a Terraform provider managing permissions at 10k+ user scale.
- Delivered a CI/CD reference pattern and an agent validating API fidelity during customer migrations.

Palantir Technologies — BD Commercial — Jul 2015 - Apr 2025

Forward Deployed Software Engineer

- Tech lead of several ~6-engineer teams creating big data processing, analysis, and operational decision-making solutions for clients across 9 industries, including leveraging Generative AI.
- Developed real-time optimization system tracking 4,000+ daily flights across 200+ airports, integrating with live air traffic & scheduling data using Kinesis, Kafka, Flink, Spark.
- Created entity resolution pipeline ingesting 1 TB/day across 60+ data sources reconciling millions of customer and transaction records for compliance teams across multiple countries.
- Led design and implementation of a regulation-compliant member engagement platform for a major US healthcare payer, streamlining outreach to millions of members, awarded patent.
- Built real-time fault tracking system ingesting high-frequency telemetry from 100+ industrial machines deployed at 20+ customers, reducing downtime by enabling anomaly detection in seconds.

Google — Helpouts, Hangouts — Jul 2013 - Jul 2015

Software Engineer

- Shipped secure messaging and consent workflows in Java and JS, plus a unified notification system spanning iOS, Android, SMS, web, and email that replaced duplicated per-client logic.

02 / EDUCATION AND RESEARCH

University of Washington · Seattle, WA

M.S. Computer Science and Engineering · Jun 2013

B.S. Computer Engineering · Jun 2012 · Cum Laude
B.A. Political Science · Jun 2012 · Cum Laude

Research Assistant · Oct 2010 - Jun 2013
Under Professor Michael Ernst

Published "**Case Studies and Tools for Contract Specifications**" in ICSE 2014: .NET binary instrumentation modifying C# for reflective variable inspection, automated invariant detection, and contract generation.

03 / TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages
Python, TypeScript, Java, Go, SQL, JS

AI & Agents
LLM inference gateways, MCP servers/clients, prompt caching, agent eval harnesses

Data & Streaming
Spark, Flink, Kafka, Redshift, PostgreSQL, Elasticsearch

Cloud & Infrastructure
AWS (EC2, S3, Kinesis), Kubernetes, Terraform, OAuth 2.0

View healthcare platform patent ↗